

On Censure or Backbiting

for

SATB Chorus

text by Benjamin Franklin
music by Christopher Kies

*duration ca. 2 minutes
(3 minutes with optional narration)*

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On Censure or Backbiting

Text by Benjamin Franklin

for unaccompanied S.A.T.B. chorus

Music by Christopher Kies

$\text{♩} = 69$

Soprano
mp *mf*
R E Or

Alto
mp
S U E

Tenor
mp
E N E

Bass
mp
On C E

4

S
B A C I T G That

A
mf
K B G That

T
mf
I N G That

B
mf
N G That

8 $\text{♩} = 90$

S
dan - ger-ous Weap - on Wit, Fright-ens a Mil - lion_ when a few you hit:

A
dan - ger-ous Weap - on Wit, Fright-ens a Mil - lion_ when a few you hit:

T
dan - ger-ous Weap - on Wit,

B
dan - ger-ous Weap - on Wit,

12 *cresc.*

S Whip but a Cur as you ride thro' a Town, And strait his Fel - low

A Whip but a Cur as you ride thro' a Town, And strait his Fel - low

T Whip but a Cur as you ride thro' a Town, And strait his Fel - low

B Whip but a Cur as you ride thro' a Town, And strait his Fel - low

Whip but a Cur as you ride thro' a Town, And strait his Fel - low

16

S Curs the Quar - rel own: Each Knave — or Fool that's con - scious of a

A Curs the Quar - rel own: Each Knave — or Fool that's con - scious of a

T Curs the Quar - rel own: Each Knave — or Fool that's con - scious of a

B Curs the Quar - rel own: Each Knave — or Fool that's con - scious of a

Curs the Quar - rel own: Each Knave — or Fool that's con - scious of a

20

S Crime — Tho' he scapes now, looks for 't an - oth - er - time.

A Crime — Tho' he scapes now, looks for 't an - oth - er - time.

T Crime — Tho' he scapes now, looks for 't an - oth - er - time.

B Crime — Tho' he scapes now, looks for 't an - oth - er - time.

Tho' he scapes now, looks for 't an - oth - er - time.

24 $\text{♩} = 69$ *mp* *mf* $\text{♩} = 132$

S R E That dan - ger - ous Weap - on

A S U R E That dan - ger - ous Weap - on

T E N R E That dan - ger - ous Weap - on

B C R E That dan - ger - ous Weap - on

28 $\text{♩} = \text{♩}$

S Wit, Whip but a Cur

A Wit, Fright - ens a Mil - lion when a few you hit: Whip but a

T Wit, Fright - ens a Mil - lion when a few you hit:

B Wit, Fright - ens a Mil - lion when a few you hit:

32 $\text{♩} = \text{♩}$

S as you ride thro' a Town, And strait his Fel - low Curs And

A Cur as you ride thro' a Town, And strait his Fel - low Curs And

T Whip but a Cur as you ride thro' a Town, And strait his Fel - low

B as you ride thro' a Town, And strait his Fel - low

36

S
A
T
B

strait his Fel - low Curs the Quar - rel own: Each

strait his Fel - low Curs the Quar - rel own: Each

strait his Fel - low Curs the Quar - rel own: Each

strait his Fel - low Curs the Quar - rel own: _____

40

S
A
T
B

Knave or Fool that's con - scious of a Crime, Tho' he scapes

Knave or Fool that's con - scious of a Crime, Tho' he scapes

Knave or Fool that's con - scious of a Crime, Tho' he scapes

_____ Tho' he scapes

44

S
A
T
B

now, looks for 't an - oth - er time. _____

now, Tho' he scapes now, looks for 't an - oth - er time. _____

now, Tho' he scapes now, looks for 't an - oth - er time. _____

now, Tho' he scapes now, looks for 't an - oth - er time. _____